

Data Dictionary

Likitha Vankadoth · Data: DCCEEW Biodiversity Offsets Scheme registers, extracted 5 Oct 2026

Definitions follow the DCCEEW *Biodiversity Offsets Scheme public registers user guide* (June 2023, Tables 2–4). Column names were standardised to lowercase with underscores. Fields marked **(added)** were created by this project.

supply_clean.csv (from the Credit Supply Register)

Column	Type	Description
credit_id	text	Unique ID for a credit holding (e.g. CR-4511)
bsa_id	text	Biodiversity Stewardship Agreement ID
credit_status	text	Issued, Pending Review, Equivalence Credit or Cancelled
date_credits_issued	date	Date the credits were issued
number_of_credits	number	Credits in the holding
ibra_region / ibra_subregion	text	IBRA bioregion and subregion where the credits are located
ecosystem_or_species	text	Ecosystem or Species credit
pct_id	integer	Plant Community Type ID (ecosystem credits only)
plant_community_type_common_name	text	PCT name (ecosystem credits only)
vegetation_formation / vegetation_class	text	Broad vegetation groupings of the PCT
offset_trading_group	text	Threatened ecological community, or group of PCTs with the same vegetation class and threat status
threatened_ecological_community_nsw	text	TEC listed under Schedule 2 of the BC Act, if applicable
hollow_bearing_trees	text	Whether hollows are present
species_id / species_scientific_name / species_common_name	text	Species details (species credits only)
suspension_ / cancellation_ / grounds_for_cancellation	date / text	Suspension and cancellation details
site_area_ha	number	Site area for expressions of interest
lga	text	Local government area
listed_date / public_register_expiry_date	date	Listing dates

Column	Type	Description
case_number	text	Case number of the listing
credit_class (added)	text	Ecosystem or Species
pct_name_key (added)	text	PCT name simplified for matching (lowercase, no punctuation)
credit_key (added)	text	Credit type used for matching: pct_name_key for ecosystem credits, scientific name for species credits

Removed for privacy: business name, phone and email; contact name, phone, mobile and email; lot and plan.

transactions_clean.csv (from the Credit Transactions Register)

Column	Type	Description
transaction_date	date	Date the transaction was approved
transaction_id	text	Case number of the transaction (leading zeros kept)
transaction_status	text	Always "Completed"
transaction_type	text	Transfer, Retire or Cancelled
from / to	text	Credit holding before and after the transaction
plant_community_type_common_name	text	PCT name (ecosystem credits)
ibra_subregion	text	IBRA subregion (renamed from "Sub Region")
offset_trading_group / vegetation_formation	text	As for supply
species_scientific_name / species_common_name	text	Species credits only
number_of_credits	number	Credits transferred or retired
price_per_credit_ex_gst	number	Sale price per credit, excluding GST
philanthropic_reason_for_transfer_disclosed	text	Yes/No, optional
retirement_reason / other_reason_for_retiring	text	Why credits were retired
reference_number_of_obligation	text	Consent or approval that imposed the obligation
local_government_area_of_obligation	text	LGA of the obligation
date_of_consent_approval	date	Date of that consent or approval

Column	Type	Description
obligation_type / obligation_assessment_method / is_planning_approval_modification	text	Obligation details
price_valid (added)	true/false	Transfer with a price above \$0
credit_class / pct_name_key / credit_key (added)	text	As for supply
pct_id (added)	integer	PCT ID looked up from the supply register by name

Removed for privacy: address of obligation.

gap_ranking.csv (output of gap_analysis.py)

Column	Description
scarcity_rank	1 = most under-supplied
credit_key / credit_class / credit_name	Credit type and readable name
offset_trading_group	Trading group for like-for-like context
available_credits	Issued + Equivalence credits in supply
pending_credits	Credits under review (possible future supply)
retired_credits / retirement_count	Total credits retired, and number of retirements
retired_per_year	$\text{retired_credits} \div \text{years of transaction data (6.8)}$
gap_credits	$\text{retired_per_year} - \text{available_credits}$
years_of_supply	$\text{available_credits} \div \text{retired_per_year}$
zero_supply	True when $\text{available_credits} = 0$

gap_by_region.csv (output of gap_analysis.py)

Column	Description
ibra_subregion / ibra_region	IBRA subregion and its bioregion
available_credits / pending_credits	All credit types in the subregion, pooled
retired_per_year	Credits retired in the subregion $\div$ years of data
years_of_supply	$\text{available_credits} \div \text{retired_per_year}$

Only subregions with at least 50 credits retired a year are included.

Price outputs (output of price_trends.py)

- **price_by_year.csv:** year, credit class, number of sales, credits sold, median price, lower and upper quartile, total value, and a partial_year flag.
- **price_by_credit_type.csv:** the gap ranking joined to each credit type's median price.

- **price_by_scarcity.csv:** median price by credit class and scarcity band.

Register data © State of New South Wales (DCCEEW), CC BY 4.0. Code and analysis: github.com/Likithaa07/nsw-biodiversity-credit-gap